Junho Kim

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Research Fields

International Trade, Geoeconomics, Political Economy

Education

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN
Ph.D. in Economics, Expected May 2027

Indiana University Bloomington Bloomington, IN
M.A. in Economics, 2025

Yonsei University Seoul, South Korea
B.A. in Economics, 2014

Working Papers

"Latent Statecraft: Political Alignment in the Shadow of Tariffs" (Job Market Paper)
with Mostafa Beshkar

Abstract: Tariffs have long been understood as a tool of economic statecraft, used not only to manage trade but to extract political returns from trading partners. This may be why tariff-cut commitments so often look lopsided: a hegemon may offer periphery countries deeper cuts than it receives in return, with the imbalance possibly compensated on a different margin, namely political concessions. Using the United States as the hegemon and UN General Assembly voting as our measure of political concessions, we measure economic concessions as the terms-of-trade effect of bilateral tariff cuts and exploit variation in their value over time. We find that periods of larger tariff concessions from the US are also periods of greater political concessions by periphery countries. This holds even absent new tariff policy: a tariff schedule's economic value is continuously revalued by shifting trade patterns, and the political returns to a concession made years earlier track this revaluation.

"Rebalancing Supply Networks after a Geopolitical Shock"

"Trade Imbalances and Reciprocity in the WTO: A Rule-Based Adjustment Framework"
with Mostafa Beshkar

Work in Progress

"Geopolitical Risk and Domestic Innovation"

"Political Shocks, Exit, and the Stability of the WTO"

Policy Papers

"Steady Growth of the Pharmaceutical Industry in Chungbuk"
BOK Golden Book, Bank of Korea, December 2018 (in Korean).

"Protectionism Status and Its Impact on Korean Exports" *with J. Park and B. Kim*
Economic Outlook, Bank of Korea, January 2017 (in Korean).

"Import Growth Outlook of Trading Partners Considering Changes in the Global Trade Structure" *with H. Lee*
Economic Outlook, Bank of Korea, October 2016 (in Korean).

Presentations

Annual Tobias Center Research Symposium, Indiana University	*(scheduled)* 2026
Hoosier Economics Conference, Indiana University	2025
Microeconomics Seminar, Indiana University	Spring, Fall 2024

Teaching Experience

Indiana University Bloomington

Instructor of Record

Fundamentals of Economics for Business II	Spring 2025, Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant

Fundamentals of Economics II	Spring 2026
Introduction to Macroeconomics	Spring 2026
Fundamentals of Economics for Business II	Summer 2025
Introduction to Applied Econometrics	Fall 2024, Fall 2022
Fundamentals of Economics for Business I	Spring 2024, Fall 2023
Statistical Analysis for Business and Economics	Spring 2023
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory	Fall 2022

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Mostafa Beshkar	Summer 2025

Professional Experience

Bank of Korea — Seoul, South Korea

Economist, Office of Bank Examination — 2020–2022

Junior Economist — 2014–2020

Research Department (Korean export outlook)
Economic Statistics Department (Balance of Payments compilation)
Chungbuk Branch

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

Lloyd Orr Graduate Fellowship, Indiana University	Fall 2026
Tobias Center Research Fund Grant, Indiana University	Fall 2025
Susan C. Thrasher Fellowship, Indiana University	Spring 2025, Fall 2025
Governor's Encouragement Award, Bank of Korea	June 2019

Other Information

Citizenship: South Korea. Currently on F-1 visa; eligible for OPT.
Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)
Programming: Stata, R, MATLAB, Python

References

Mostafa Beshkar (Chair)
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Sarah Bauerle Danzman
Associate Professor
International Studies, Indiana University
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